



Making Sense of Attachment Science

Phase 1, Week 4: Please *complete* this workbook before this week's group call

The foundation beneath all 10 Transformational Parenting Pillars is a willingness, capacity, and capability to **Show Up!**

How do you tend to show up in your most intimate and vulnerable relationships? Especially in moments of tension, uncertainty, conflict, or stress.

Showing up means we are:

Present: We consciously commit to be as present as we can be in our body, heart, and mind. Our presence is not perfect one hundred percent of the time. It does not mean we do nothing except serve our child. It means, rather, we are willing to practice the art of presence. We are willing to actively question and deconstruct whatever lies within and around us that keeps us from accessing full presence in the moment. We commit to cultivating trust with our intuition so we can attune with and appropriately meet our child where they are, in that moment, not where they "should be." Where they are, period. From a space of devotion for the moment, we see. We connect. The answers flow and we follow the connection between ourselves and our child.

Perseverant: We consciously commit to the process. We abandon the mindset obsessed with immediate results! We commit to moving through the inevitable expansions and contractions of connection with our children with resilience and flexibility.

Purposeful: We consciously commit to the deeper purpose behind our presence. We trust that truly, what a child of any age needs, is a caregiver who believes and has faith in the power of relationship. A caregiver who reveres the relationship as the center center in the family's tapestry. We believe in the power of presence, connection, trust, and intuition. When we boil complex science down to its most distilled essence, we find time and again that connection is the answer.



Pause. Inhale. Exhale.

This is a life-long process. It is never too late to begin and commit to presence. It is never too late to shift away from managing behaviors and begin prioritizing connection.

Wherever you are in your current ability, capacity, and willingness to show up is okay.

You are welcome here.

We recognize creating a secure attachment is a pivotal priority, while embracing the complex understanding that a secure attachment does not guarantee a life of complete ease and well-being. We advocate for a secure attachment because this will serve as a solid foundation for both the parent and the child.

When difficulty and strife arise within the family system, or interpersonally for any member of the family, we want you and your children to access a deep well of resiliency and a core belief: *All is well. This will pass. I am held. I am capable.*

In regard to children or parents with neurodiversity, mental or physical health challenges or disabilities, we understand that even when raised with a secure attachment, these people may still struggle in their life experience at times. We offer compassion and realism in these situations. There are external, systemic, and cultural realities that can create mild to severe challenges for parents to show up for themselves and their children.

It is not all or nothing.

We cannot hold ourselves to the expectation that we will show up perfectly, one hundred percent of the time. We will each do our best to show up as often as we can with presence, perseverance, and purpose. We will believe that when we can show up, it matters!

According to Daniel Siegel and Tina Payne Bryson in their book *The Power of Showing Up*, a secure attachment is the “ultimate goal” for parents. Let’s discuss what gets in our way of showing up for ourselves and our children: the three expressions of insecure attachment in the adult who is parenting.

Your Attachment Orientation is your brain and body’s way of organizing behavior to meet your need for security and safety (connection).



Attachment science explains our brain and body's understanding of:

Connection to self and others: Connection and intimacy are safe and dependable or dangerous and/or unpredictable. If the attachment center in the brain has been repeatedly shown that connection is dependable, and you can count on others to accurately meet your needs, an infant grows with an innate belief: When I need help, support, and safety, this will happen for me. I can count on others in my most vulnerable moments. It shows the brain and body that reaching out for connection and support from another will help you feel **BETTER**, not **WORSE**. This helps the child to feel relaxed and safe within, therefore able to develop with as much health and well being as possible for their genetic blueprint.

Embodied Emotions: Our emotions are manageable, and our bodies are to be trusted or emotions are dangerous, and our bodies cannot survive intense stress. When the child is met consistently and reliably with warmth, empathy, and validation to their often very strong and very loud emotional expression, day or night, the emotional and hormonal center in the brain develops in the healthiest expression, reaching its full potential. This sets up children for a greater chance to experience emotional equilibrium, access to self-soothing as they age, and an overall sense of safety and well being, no matter the strong, albeit temporary, emotions that course through their body.

Self-Organizing Mind: Our inner world makes sense, and we are worthy of being known, seen, heard, and understood or who we are does not make sense and we do not deserve to be understood, seen, heard, and accepted. When our children are consistently and reliably met with curiosity and a willingness to see BENEATH their behavior towards their needs, thought process, and perception, our children grow with an ability to pause and self-reflect. They have access to a solid sense of self, and can look within and access a sturdy sense of esteem and worth.

The quality of attachment we, as the adult, received in OUR infancy and childhood, has created the quality of our own attachment to the above three components. While not set in stone, as our attachment can heal and mend itself throughout our entire lives, to SHOW UP for our children and ourselves, we must begin the process of "earning a secure attachment" if we find ourselves experiencing more *insecure* moments than *secure*.

Secure Attachment

As a child, especially in your first few years of life, your primary caregiver:

- Was self-connected and felt trusted to be your caretaker.
- Felt connected to their intuition to respond to you; released any outside advice that did not align with what felt right for them and their baby/child.
- Mirrored your facial expressions.
- Gave you verbal empathy like: "You feel a bit down today?" or "Do you need a hand? I am wondering if you're needing support with that?"
- Offered you grounded care: "Come here, hon, I've got a hug for you."
- Understood your behaviors while trying to meet your needs and was not threatened or afraid of the behaviors; could accurately interpret what you were trying to communicate beneath your behaviors.
- Encouraged you to discuss your feelings, hopes, dreams, wishes, and was able to "hold space" for you and actively listen, versus fix, problem solve, or shut down.
- Apologized to you when a mistake was made, without being self-deprecating.
- Soothed you in the way your unique system needed, whenever you needed it, day or night.
- Met their own needs and was proactive in requesting support.
- Guessed what you were thinking to better understand your actions.
- Communicated with you to understand and connect, instead of needing to be right or make a point; was willing to receive feedback and even be "wrong."
- Was not perfect! They modeled self-compassion and an understanding that striving for perfection was impossible.

As a parent, with yourself, you may find that more often than not:

- You pay attention to your body and what it is communicating to you.
- You pay attention to your feelings and embrace them as "communicators with messages."
- You remember your childhood with compassion and understanding. You have made a coherent narrative.



- When you make a mistake, you can forgive yourself easily and take accountability to make sure it does not happen again.
- You are actively engaged in friendships and community and understand this as a CORE component of health and well being; you have the ability to emotionally regulate.
- You know what you need and believe you're inherently worthy of getting those needs met.
- You are connected to your intuition and double check any advice you receive, from experts or otherwise, with what you feel to be right and true for you and your child.
- You feel confident in your communication and have a strong "window of tolerance" when negotiating contrasting needs/wants/desires.
- You are willing to get curious about your instinctual responses during stress, and continue to cultivate healthy and connection coping skills in your relationships.
- You believe that both you and your child are special and valuable, worthy of prioritizing. It's either/or, it's both/and.

As a parent, with your child:

- You feel confident providing a haven and a secure base for your child.
- You can see beneath the child's behavior into their feelings and needs.
- You turn toward your child with grounded awareness when they seek closeness and connection.
- You can recognize and differentiate between the experiences, thoughts, and feelings of yourself and your child.
- If your child is upset or grumpy, you can remain grounded and connected to joy anyway.
- You can model regulation and soothe your child (*no matter their age!*) when needed.
- You can communicate feelings and needs directly without passive-aggressiveness, making your child guess what is going on, or giving the child the silent treatment.
- You can prioritize emotional, physical, psychological, and spiritual bonds with children despite criticism from others.
- You can actively decondition your parenting from punishments or any power over or under parenting tactic.

Your child:

- Believes they are worthy of love.
- Accepts your bid for connection.
- Can verbalize boundaries in a clear way (7 and older): "Mom, please shut my door, I want space." **Note: when the child is stressed (at any age) clear communication may significantly decrease!*
- Is more willing to work as a team and has empathy for actions (7 and older).
- Can regulate their own emotions and self-soothe some of the time, knowing that even adults need co-regulation, rather than self-regulation, some of the time (7 and older).
- Welcomes your longing to support the child to be soothed (especially infant-7).
- Is drawn to friendship circles that enhance their self-esteem and mirror a healthy lifestyle (7-teens).
- Can focus on academics and maintain concentration (7 and older). **Even children with a secure attachment may struggle with diagnoses such as ADD and ADHD. Being securely attached can help reduce the symptoms of both of these neurological experiences.*
- Is independent, with a healthy relationship, self-agency, and self-awareness (12 and older).
- Believes that life is good, that they are worthy, and that no matter the difficulties, they will find a way to work through them.
- If living with neurodiversity or a mental and or physical illness, they can be more capable of accessing self-acceptance and trust within their life experience.
- Is not perfect, and is at peace with this.

Insecure Avoidant Attachment

As a child, your primary caregiver:

- May have ignored you and your attempts to meet your needs for connection.
- Was not present in their body.
- May have become angry at you often for small things and had limited capacity for feeling or witnessing emotions.
- Fled the room or forced you to move out of their proximity when you expressed emotions they could not cope with.
- May have struggled with vulnerability and avoided close connection with you.
- Didn't share much about themselves and typically stayed quiet and non-descript.
- May have expressed, verbally or nonverbally, that you were a burden or a "handful," perhaps having this belief about themselves as well.

As a parent, with yourself, you may:

- Feel numb to your feelings and your body.
- Struggle to truly connect to those closest to you, or let someone close to you.
- Not remember your childhood.
- Want to reach out and offer or receive warmth and comfort, but your body seems to be "stuck."
- Dismiss your childhood as "Yeah, I was mistreated, but now I'm fine!" This may manifest as a very literal and logical way of making sense of your life, without considering the more subtle nuances like emotion, connection, and relationships.
- Not take time to self-reflect and be curious about your inner experiences.
- Offer yourself very little to no self-care, mostly working or staying busy with tasks.
- Want to run away, literally, when you are experiencing stress.
- Avoid conflict and "sweep things under the rug."
- Not communicate your needs, because you do not know what they are and assume they will not get met anyway. You just "don't have too many needs."
- Want to do better for your child, but have trouble connecting in meaningful ways.
- Live with a deep-seated fear of rejection.

As a parent, with your child, you may:

- Sense a “dismissive” attachment with your child. Just not able to truly connect and understand what they need.
- See your child as “needy” and feel resentful at times, or suffocated about how much they depend on you.
- Want your child to be self-sufficient at an incredibly young age. *Note: Even when a child is “old enough” to do things, they often still want their special person by their side!
- Need a lot of space from your child and view your child as “clingy.”
- Struggle to hold space for your child’s feelings and think they are “over dramatic.”
- Deny vulnerability.
- Focus on hyper independence.
- Tend to boost their self-image by ignoring or rejecting any negative beliefs about themselves. This can manifest as “toxic positivity.”
- Want your child to self-soothe at a young age. *Note: Children need inter-soothing, or “borrowing their parent’s calm,” until around age 12. This need never goes away: humans need each other!
- Place extreme emphasis on science and material evidence, and feel that emotions are uncomfortable and inconvenient.

Your child: *(Caveat: these manifestations could be from an insecure avoidant attachment, or other mental or physical health diagnoses. Remember, attachment is not etched in stone, the brain and nervous system can ALWAYS heal and mend through connection and safe, empathic relating.)*

- Avoids connection with you; would rather be alone.
- Does not communicate how they feel or what they think. They may shut down or hide away from you when a conversation needs to be had.
- Seems withdrawn, “spacey,” and has trouble focusing or concentrating.
- Struggles with memory and may appear irresponsible.
- Struggles with emotional regulation, erupts and won’t allow you to soothe them.
- May struggle with empathy for siblings or others. *Note: The anterior insular cortex, which drives empathy, takes many years to fully develop. As a result, empathy should not always be expected. It begins to develop around age 9.

If you notice these tendencies in your child, it is OKAY. We understand that reading this may bring up feelings of overwhelm, fear, shame, remorse, anger, skepticism, apathy and more. These feelings make complete sense! If you, and/or your child lives with an avoidant attachment system this is not bad or wrong. It just is. You are here to learn how to support your child to feel more safe, secure, and self-connected. There is hope.

The SuperPowers of Avoidant Attachment

Yes, an avoidant attachment is considered insecure. And, that does not mean that you are “less than” a person with a secure attachment. We will not have more moments of inner security if we are demonizing the avoidant attachment style. To support you to find grace and unconditional acceptance for your experience, let’s explore the strengths of an avoidant attachment.

As a parent living with moments of avoidance, your strengths may be:

- Giving your child a lot of space and freedom. You don’t struggle with hovering or always needing to be involved in what they are doing.
- Modeling independence and teaching your children how to do things on their own in a way that truly serves them.
- Respecting your child’s boundaries because you know how important it is for people to give you the space you need.
- Easily accessing the positive side to difficult situations, which can serve your child to have an ability to look at the glass as half full.
- Feeling quite confident as a parent, and not spending a lot of time in self-doubt.

Insecure Ambivalent Attachment

As a child, your primary caregiver:

- May have given help when you did not need it, and withheld help when you did.
- May have believed they needed to save you from your feelings, with constant reassurance or distraction from upsets.
- Was not emotionally reliable; sometimes very present & warm, sometimes distant & cold.
- Felt very insecure and afraid of their job as a parent. Constantly doubted themselves.
- Experienced a lot of anxiety while tending to you, which as a child you inevitably absorbed into your developing brain and nervous system.
- May have expressed with body language and/or verbal cues that you were stupid, incompetent, not able to do anything right, or “will never learn!” Or, they may have had these unconscious beliefs about themselves, which radiated as unspoken and “normalized” truths within the family system.

As a parent, with yourself, you may:

- Experience an anxious disposition: feeling anxious about feeling anxious.
- Get lost in worst case scenarios.
- Feel emotionally unstable, go through a roller coaster of feelings quickly, and feel unable to find a sense of calm.
- Start projects and not follow through.
- Have chronic self-doubt as a parent.
- Struggle with shame and beliefs of worthlessness.
- Swing between feeling confident and secure, to lost and anxious.
- Feel strong self-blame and believe you are unworthy of love.
- Rely heavily on others because you “just can’t do it.”
- Worry chronically about your child, how you’re “not doing enough” or “failing” them.

As a parent, with your child, you may:

- Sense a “preoccupied attachment” to your child. (Review this important concept in *The Power of Showing Up*, if necessary.)
- Not set limits or expectations, fearing that your child is going to be mad at you.
- Have difficulty giving your child space when requested, or allowing anyone else to help; constantly worry that your child needs you to rescue them.
- Feel the need for your child to be calm and regulated, so YOU can be calm and regulated.
- Worry about your child's well being and obsess over illness or worst case scenarios.

Your child: *(Caveat: these manifestations could be from an insecure ambivalent attachment, or other mental and physical health diagnoses.)*

- Struggles with anxiety.
- Is fearful of uncertainty.
- Struggles to connect with friends.
- Doesn't want to leave the house, and wants to be with their caregiver at all times.
- Struggles to self-regulate and has many “episodes” of emotional eruption a day.
- Struggles with focus; experiences a mind that is “constantly spinning.”

The SuperPowers of Ambivalent Attachment

Yes, an ambivalent or anxious attachment is considered insecure. And, that does not mean that you are “less than” than a person with a secure attachment. We will not have more moments of inner security if we are demonizing the ambivalent attachment style. To support you to find grace and unconditional acceptance for your experience, let's explore the strengths of an ambivalent attachment.

As a parent living with moments of ambivalence, your strengths may be:

- A HUGE heart! You care deeply and strongly.
- Constantly learning and trying to grow, evolve, and heal.
- When you can, you may thrive at tuning into your child's feelings and needs.
- Parenting is your priority and you will make life changes necessary for your children to be in the center.
- Usually caring and considerate of how your actions will impact your child, and are willing to take responsibility for your actions.



Insecure Disorganized Attachment

As a child, your primary caregiver may have:

- Acted in ways that scared you, with no repair process in place after scary events.
- Feared your feelings, especially your cries. Your emotions were “too much.”
- Been emotionally distraught much of the time (whether outward presenting, or something that you sensed).
- Practiced authoritarian parenting; was not able to create a safe environment or protect you from harm.
- Swung between despondent and depressed, and angry and erratic.
- Screamed chronically, used name calling, threats, shame and fear tactics to control your behavior.
- Used corporal punishment: the intentional use of physical force to cause bodily pain or discomfort as a penalty for unacceptable behavior. Includes any action that produces discomfort, such as: spanking (even when done calmly), hitting, slapping, pinching, ear pulling, jabbing, shoving, or choking.

As a parent, with yourself, you may:

- Have difficulty staying focused and on task, feeling confused and “swirly” on the inside much of the time.
- Be unable to cope with stress and feel very disoriented about your thoughts or feelings.
- Experience a sense of not really existing, like you’re here, but you’re not here.
- Have moments of physical aggression and violence.
- Go through extreme highs and lows.
- Have exceptionally low tolerance for loud noise, or conflict between siblings.
- Feel very lost and alone deep down.

As a parent, with your child, you may:

- Become enraged very easily, snapping nearly every day, experiencing feelings of total hate and rage for your child(ren) that seemingly come from nowhere.
- Scream, hit, threaten with violence, or use derogatory language to get your children to obey.
- Feel “out of control” much of the time.
- Struggle with chronic reactivity and be unable to tolerate your child’s big feelings.
- Take your child’s behaviors and words very personally.
- Feel that any kind of feedback from your child is harsh criticism of you.
- Become angry easily and direct your anger onto your child, making your child fear you.
- Struggle to have any kind of connection with your child other than “command and obey.”

Your child: *(Caveat: these manifestations could be from an insecure disorganized attachment, or other mental or physical health diagnoses.)*

- May be consistently eruptive, becoming angry and “snapping” over little things.
- May not trust authority figures and not like to listen to anyone in a “power over” position.
- May use violence and aggression in order to meet their needs for connection or being seen and heard.
- Does not compromise and talks back; their brain has already wired itself to defend against anything a parent or other authority says to them.
- Uses hate speech to parents or siblings and seems defiant or out of control.
- May want you suddenly, then reject you right away.
- Seems very fearful and suspicious.
- Struggles with huge outbursts of rage, and will not receive any support from any caregiver.
- Holds a belief that adults are dangerous and not to be trusted.
- Oscillates between being “unreachable” and shut down and being “out of control” and aggressive

The SuperPowers of Disorganized Attachment

Yes, a disorganized attachment is considered insecure. And, that does not mean that you are “less than” than a person with a secure attachment. We will not have more moments of inner security if we are demonizing the disorganized attachment style. To support you to find grace and unconditional acceptance for your experience, let’s explore the strengths of a disorganized attachment.

As a parent living with moments of disorganization and disequilibrium, your strengths may be:

- When able, you do seek connection with your child.
- You care a lot about your relationship with your child, and can access moments of genuine desire to improve and be a safe harbor for your child.
- You can experience both independence as a parent and immersion in parenting.
- You love deeply.
- When you can access a positive state of mind, gratitude and appreciation can overwhelm you in a pleasant way.
- You are creative, able to see all sides of a situation when in a calm state.
- Usually very compassionate for animals or other people who experience suffering.



Your History is Not Your Destiny

"I am not to blame for what happened to me, and I AM responsible for what I do now."

One way of earning a secure attachment is to make sense of, and begin making peace with, your attachment history. This way you can consciously choose how you wish to move forward into the destiny of your attachment style.

Cultivating more moments of security within your attachment system will provide you with a sense of inner safety and security, greater regulation of emotions by being able to "ride the waves," the ability to find calm, and the chance to experience more joy and creativity!

You are here to learn who YOU are, so you can see your child clearly, beneath their behaviors and the natural process of maturation. **You are here to know YOU, so you can be the leader of the WE between you and your child.**

If you're feeling doubtful about dredging up your past, please trust that we will do this slowly. You are in the driver's seat and can choose how "deep" you're willing to explore your childhood and past experiences.

"Thinking of painful childhood experiences like a dog bite... we can understand how our natural impulse is to pull away from it. So if a dog bites you on the hand, and you pull your hand away, he digs his teeth in even more strongly and your struggle worsens the injury of the bite. But if instead you shove your hand down the dog's throat, he'll gag and actually release his grip on your hand - minimizing the damage and optimizing the healing. Trauma (described here as a lack of security in childhood attachment) is just like that. We naturally pull away from reflecting on trauma, not wanting to be flooded by the painful memories or thinking, "It's in the past, what's the point of dwelling on something you can't change?" But, memory retrieval when combined with narrative reflection can be a memory modifier."

— Daniel Siegel & Tiny Payne Bryson, *The Power of Showing Up*



Your Writing Exercises

Exercise 1: Write a Letter To Your Parent(s) or Primary Caregiver(s)

They will not read this. No filter. Let your truth flow. It is NOT a betrayal. It is not actually about them. This is about YOU being able to begin the process of creating coherency. If we have all of that emotion blocked inside of our body, we will face continuous barriers on our growth journey and continue to struggle with the same obstacles in our parenting, and in our life.

You can express your gratitude for ways in which they showed up in security for you.

You can develop compassion for them as you understand more of the WHY behind their struggle to raise you with more secure moments than not. You can express your heartbreak and agony about the ways they did not. You can express your anger. NO FILTER. You can express your apathy and discomfort that you can't remember whether or not they showed up in security or insecurity. Don't overthink this!

CRUCIAL. Do not stop writing until you've let it all out. Let yourself write until you feel a release. It may take more than one time to find that release. Trust your process.



Exercise 2: Write a Letter To Yourself

Describe the ways you show up for yourself. Describe the ways you do not. Share your pain, your longing, your regret. Share your willingness to show up with more unconditional love, acceptance, and grace for yourself. Keep writing until you feel a release.



Exercise 3: Write a Letter To Your Child(ren)

They do not need to read this; it is for you. Share how you show up for them with security. Own up about the times you fall into insecure attachment responses. Validate how that might make them feel. Share how you do not show up with security. Express your feelings, whatever they are. Commit to your child(ren), from your heart, how you long to show up for them moving forward.

Exercise 4: Write a Letter To Your Future Self

This is your self after going through this transformation, weaving a more coherent narrative, gaining skills and self-awareness. How does your future self show up? What kind of capabilities, skills, and qualities does your future self have? How is your connection with yourself, in the future, going to be more secure? How is your connection in the future with your children going to be more secure? Express your feelings, and do not stop until you are complete.

One Last Thing

Today we explored your most predominant attachment style. This was created within the first few years of your life with your primary caregiver. It is possible that it has shifted and grown through your adolescent and adult life. We invite you to embrace this exercise as an opportunity to grow in self-awareness, not a diagnosis or label to box yourself in, or a tool of harm that you use to blame and fault yourself. This conversation expands beyond your personal experience: attachment is generational, cultural, and contextual.

If you notice throughout this workbook that you need more mental health support than coaching offers you, we highly recommend seeking out professional help with an attachment-trauma trained counselor or therapist. As human beings we are still on the precipice of understanding how complex and nuanced attachment presents itself within our everyday experiences. It is very common that you and your child(ren) experience insecure and secure attachment on a continuum, flowing fluidly up and down the “scale of security.”

This exercise is not meant to limit you, or create fear and urgency within you. With self-awareness and naming comes reassurance and an opportunity for self-responsibility. Furthermore, we reiterate that while you may have given your child(ren) everything within the parameters of a secure attachment, they may still struggle at times with behaviors and experiences observed on the insecure attachment checklist. This could be age, or a pre-existing mental or emotional health condition. This workbook can not unpack all of the factors that could be contributing to your child’s well being, including mental health diagnoses. If you feel your child is in need of additional support, we recommend consultation with an occupational therapist or play therapist for young children. For older children, they may benefit from working with a coach, counselor, or therapist themselves.

Because attachment styles are passed down through a lineage, it is likely that you have inherited your primary caregiver(s)’ attachment style. Research in neuroplasticity (the brain’s ability to modify its connections or rewire itself) shows us that although you may have inherited an insecure attachment from your caregiver in your first few years of life, your attachment system is capable of healing and finding security at ANY point in your life. This means healing is always possible, and it is never too late to begin developing more security within yourself, with your child, and within your child’s inner system. Hope is a beautiful thing! Take heart. The work you are doing now MATTERS. We will inch our way to more and more moments of security, together.



Summary

Takeaways:

- **Attachment Orientation** is your brain's way of organizing behavior to meet your need for security (connection).
- **Secure Attachment** results from a relationship with consistent physical and emotional safety, letting the child be seen, and letting the child be soothed.
- **Insecure Avoidant Attachment** includes behaviors that seek to avoid, hide from, or ignore strong feelings.
 - Superpowers may include confidence, independence, giving your child extra space and freedom, respecting your child's boundaries
- **Insecure Ambivalent Attachment** includes behaviors that aim to fix, change, or prevent strong feelings, often resulting in anxiety or doubt.
 - Superpowers may include caring deeply and tuning into your child, taking responsibility for your actions, learning and growing as you evolve
- **Insecure Disorganized Attachment** includes behaviors that can seem extreme and erratic, vacillating between warm and threatening, volatile and highly reactive.
 - Superpowers may include compassion and creativity, a strong desire for connection, and a deep sense of gratitude and appreciation.

Invitation to Practice:

- **Remind yourself daily** that your goal is to develop your own secure attachment and create a secure attachment with your child.
- **Affirm regularly:** I can make sense of my past in order to create a different future.
- When you become aware of responding through insecure attachment, give yourself time to **create a coherent narrative** around the specific experience:
 - *I showed these behaviors ____ because I was feeling ____ in that moment.*
 - *I realize now that I was needing _____.*
 - *It makes sense that I reacted this way. I recognize this as a pattern.*
 - *In the future I commit to meeting my needs, honoring my feelings, and choosing to express them in a healthy way.*
- **Commit to repairing the connection** with your child after a damaging interaction.
- **Aim to offer “sparkly eyes” to your child**, especially in their times of distress.

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